

Windows has two sets of environment variables: *system environment variables* (which apply to all users) and *user environment variables* (which override the system environment variable but apply to the current user only). To edit them, click the Start menu and then enter `Edit environment variables for your account`, which opens the Environment Variables window, as shown in [Figure 2-6](#).

Select **Path** from the user variable list (not the system variable list), click **Edit**, add the new folder name in the text field that appears (don't forget the semicolon separator), and click **OK**.

This interface isn't the easiest to work with, so if you're frequently editing environment variables on Windows, I recommend installing the free Rapid Environment Editor software from <https://www.rapidee.com/>. Note that after installing it, you must run this software as the administrator to edit system environment variables. Click the Start menu, type `Rapid Environment Editor`, right-click the software's icon, and click **Run as administrator**.

From the Command Prompt, you can permanently modify the system `PATH` variable using the `setx` command:

```
C:\Users\Al>setx /M PATH "C:\newFolder;%PATH%"
```

You'll need to run the Command Prompt as the administrator to run the `setx` command.